

SPECIALTY DRUG PRIOR AUTHORIZATION REQUEST

Anvara Health Plan | Form AHP-PA-4412 | rev 2026-01 | Policy AHP-SPX-118

SECTION A - PATIENT AND COVERAGE

PATIENT NAME Marcus Ellison		DATE OF BIRTH 1971-06-18		SEX Male	
MEMBER ID AVH884210277		GROUP NUMBER GRP-77120		COVERAGE EFFECTIVE 2026-01-01	
PLAN Anvara Health Plan · Anvara Choice PPO			BENEFIT Pharmacy · Specialty tier 4		

SECTION B - PRESCRIBER

PRESCRIBER Dana Whitfield, MD		NPI 1730458822	
SPECIALTY Dermatology		PRACTICE Lakeside Dermatology & Immunology	
PHONE (847) 555-0142		FAX (847) 555-0143	
		TAX ID 36-4471902	

SECTION C - REQUESTED THERAPY

REQUESTED PRODUCT Velunexa (velunekimab) 150 mg/mL			J-CODE J3592		
NDC 58291-0150-01		DOSE 150 mg		ROUTE Subcutaneous	
FREQUENCY Weeks 0 and 4, then every 12 weeks		QUANTITY 1 syringe per fill		DAYS SUPPLY 84	
DIAGNOSIS L40.0 · Psoriasis vulgaris (moderate-to-severe plaque)		ICD-10 L40.0		REQUEST TYPE Initial · Standard	
SITE OF CARE Self-administered · specialty pharmacy		REQUESTED START 2026-09-08		DURATION REQUESTED 12 months	

SECTION D - CLINICAL REVIEW QUESTIONS

Answer every question from the submitted documentation. For each answer, identify the document and page it is supported by.

#	QUESTION	ANSWER	SUPPORTING DOCUMENT / PAGE
1	What specialty drug is being requested?	Velunexa (velunekimab) 150 mg/mL	Enrollment p1
2	What is the primary diagnosis for the request?	L40.0 Psoriasis vulgaris	Medical Necessity p1
3	What is the documented disease severity?	BSA 18%, PASI 16.4	Chart Note p1
4	How long has the patient been treated for this condition?	26 months	Chart Note p1
5	Has a conventional systemic agent been tried?	Yes	Medical Necessity p1
6	What prior therapy was attempted, and for how long?	Methotrexate 20 mg weekly for 16 weeks	Medical Necessity p1
7	Did the patient respond to prior therapy?	No	Chart Note p1
8	Has tuberculosis screening been completed?	Yes — negative, 2026-07-18	Lab Report p1
9	Is all required supporting documentation available?	Yes	Policy p1

SECTION E - ATTESTATION

I certify that the information provided is accurate and that the requested therapy is medically necessary.

SUBMITTER NAME A. Reyes, RN	TITLE Hub clinical reviewer	DATE 2026-08-26
SIGNATURE A. Reyes, RN	HUB CASE HUB-2041	TRACKING AHP-20260826-2041

This form is provided for demonstration purposes and is not the form of any real health plan.

PRESCRIBER ENROLLMENT / START FORM

Velunexa (velunekimab) 150 mg/mL · Interleukin-23p19 inhibitor

SECTION 1 - PATIENT INFORMATION

PATIENT NAME Marcus Ellison	DATE OF BIRTH 1971-06-18	SEX Male
HUB PATIENT ID PT-4471002	PHONE (312) 555-0148	CONSENT ON FILE Yes · 2026-08-24
HOME ADDRESS 1184 Ashgrove Lane, Evanston, IL 60201		

SECTION 2 - INSURANCE

PAYER Anvara Health Plan	PLAN Anvara Choice PPO	
MEMBER ID AVH884210277	GROUP NUMBER GRP-77120	COVERAGE EFFECTIVE 2026-01-01
BENEFIT Pharmacy · Specialty tier 4	SECONDARY COVERAGE None reported	

SECTION 3 - PRESCRIBER

PRESCRIBER Dana Whitfield, MD	NPI 1730458822	TAX ID 36-4471902
SPECIALTY Dermatology	PRACTICE Lakeside Dermatology & Immunology	
PHONE (847) 555-0142	FAX (847) 555-0143	

SECTION 4 - PRESCRIPTION

PRODUCT Velunexa (velunekimab) 150 mg/mL	J-CODE J3592	
NDC 58291-0150-01	STRENGTH 150 mg/mL single-dose prefilled syringe	
DOSE 150 mg	ROUTE Subcutaneous	FREQUENCY Weeks 0 and 4, then every 12 weeks
QUANTITY 1 syringe per fill	DAYS SUPPLY 84	DURATION REQUESTED 12 months
SITE OF CARE Self-administered · specialty pharmacy		REQUESTED START 2026-09-08
DIAGNOSIS L40.0 · Psoriasis vulgaris (moderate-to-severe plaque)		REQUEST TYPE Initial · Standard

SECTION 5 - PRESCRIBER NOTES

Patient has completed the ArvelisConnect enrollment and consent forms. Please initiate benefits investigation and prior authorization. Patient prefers shipment to home address. Nurse injection training requested for first dose.

SECTION 6 - PRESCRIBER SIGNATURE

SIGNATURE Dana Whitfield	TITLE MD	DATE SIGNED 2026-08-24
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STATEMENT OF MEDICAL NECESSITY

Velunexa (velunekimab) 150 mg/mL · Submitted to Anvara Health Plan

Patient Marcus Ellison · DOB 1971-06-18 · Male
Member ID AVH884210277 · Anvara Health Plan · Anvara Choice PPO
Requested product Velunexa (velunekimab) 150 mg/mL · J-code J3592
Regimen 150 mg subcutaneous, weeks 0 and 4, then every 12 weeks
Diagnosis L40.0 · Psoriasis vulgaris (moderate-to-severe plaque)

DIAGNOSIS AND HISTORY

Marcus Ellison is a 54-year-old man with a 26 month history of moderate-to-severe plaque psoriasis, diagnosed in June 2024 and managed continuously in this practice since that time. Involvement is widespread across the trunk, extensor surfaces of both arms, and both shins.

DISEASE SEVERITY

At today's visit body surface area involvement measures 18 percent and the PASI score is 16.4. The patient reports persistent pruritus interfering with sleep on most nights and has withdrawn from swimming, which he previously did three times a week. The Dermatology Life Quality Index is 17.

PRIOR THERAPY

The patient completed a trial of methotrexate 20 mg orally once weekly with folic acid supplementation, initiated 2025-11-04 and continued through 2026-02-24, a total of 16 weeks at a therapeutic dose. Adherence was verified through pharmacy refill history. PASI at week 16 was 15.9 against a pre-treatment PASI of 16.8, representing no clinically meaningful improvement. Methotrexate was discontinued for lack of efficacy, not for intolerance or cost.

Prior to systemic therapy the patient used clobetasol propionate 0.05 percent ointment and calcipotriene 0.005 percent for a combined nine months, and completed 24 sessions of narrowband UVB phototherapy between March and June 2025 with partial and non-durable response.

CLINICAL RATIONALE FOR THE REQUESTED PRODUCT

Velunexa is requested as the next line of therapy. Interleukin-23p19 inhibition is appropriate for a patient with widespread plaque disease refractory to conventional systemic therapy and phototherapy, and the every-twelve-week maintenance interval suits a patient whose adherence to weekly dosing has been a barrier. Tuberculosis and hepatitis screening are complete and negative, and there is no history of malignancy, active infection, or inflammatory bowel disease.

PRESCRIBER ATTESTATION

I certify that the information above is accurate, that I have personally examined this patient, and that Velunexa is medically necessary for the treatment of this condition.

PRESCRIBER SIGNATURE Dana Whitfield	TITLE MD	DATE 2026-08-24
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DERMATOLOGY PROGRESS NOTE

Follow-up visit · Established patient

Patient Marcus Ellison · 54M · DOB 1971-06-18
Patient ID PT-4471002
Primary diagnosis L40.0 · Psoriasis vulgaris (moderate-to-severe plaque)

SUBJECTIVE

The patient returns for follow-up of moderate-to-severe plaque psoriasis, first diagnosed 26 months ago. He reports plaques on the trunk, both extensor forearms, and both shins that have not improved since the last visit. Pruritus wakes him most nights and he rates it 7 out of 10. He completed 16 weeks of methotrexate 20 mg weekly ending 2026-02-24 with no meaningful change and stopped it on my instruction for lack of efficacy. He denies fever, joint pain, morning stiffness, and gastrointestinal symptoms. He has not travelled outside the United States in the past two years.

OBJECTIVE

Well-appearing man in no distress. Skin examination shows well-demarcated erythematous plaques with adherent silvery scale over the trunk, bilateral extensor forearms, and bilateral shins. Body surface area involvement measures 18 percent by palm method. PASI is 16.4 (erythema 3, induration 3, desquamation 3 averaged across regions). No nail pitting or onycholysis. No joint swelling or tenderness. No lymphadenopathy.

ASSESSMENT

Moderate-to-severe plaque psoriasis, L40.0, refractory to conventional systemic therapy and to narrowband UVB phototherapy. Body surface area 18 percent, PASI 16.4, DLQI 17. No clinically meaningful improvement on a completed 16 week methotrexate trial at a therapeutic dose. No contraindication to biologic therapy identified. Tuberculosis and hepatitis screening negative on 2026-07-18.

PLAN

Initiate Velunexa (velunekimab) 150 mg subcutaneously at weeks 0 and 4, then every 12 weeks. Enroll through ArvelisConnect for benefits investigation and prior authorization. Nurse injection training at first dose. Continue topical clobetasol as needed for breakthrough plaques. Recheck PASI and body surface area in 12 weeks. Repeat tuberculosis screening annually.

ELECTRONICALLY SIGNED BY	DATE / TIME
Dana Whitfield, MD	2026-08-24 14:02

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LABORATORY & TB SCREENING REPORT

Ordered by Dana Whitfield, MD · Lakeside Dermatology & Immunology

Patient
Patient ID
Collected
Reported

Marcus Ellison · DOB 1971-06-18 · Male
PT-4471002
2026-07-18
2026-07-18

RESULTS			
TEST	RESULT	REFERENCE RANGE	COLLECTED
QuantiFERON-TB Gold Plus	Negative	Negative	2026-07-18
Hepatitis B surface antigen	Non-reactive	Non-reactive	2026-07-18
Hepatitis C antibody	Non-reactive	Non-reactive	2026-07-18
ALT	26 U/L	7 - 55 U/L	2026-07-18
AST	23 U/L	8 - 48 U/L	2026-07-18
Creatinine	0.94 mg/dL	0.74 - 1.35 mg/dL	2026-07-18
WBC	6.8 K/uL	4.5 - 11.0 K/uL	2026-07-18

INTERPRETATION			
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Screening panel drawn prior to initiation of biologic therapy. QuantiFERON-TB Gold Plus negative. Hepatitis B surface antigen and hepatitis C antibody non-reactive. Hepatic and renal function within reference range.

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MEDICAL POLICY AHP-SPX-118

Anvara Health Plan | Interleukin-23 Inhibitors for Plaque Psoriasis | Effective 2026-01-01

SCOPE

This policy establishes the medical necessity criteria applied by Anvara Health Plan to requests for interleukin-23 inhibitors for plaque psoriasis for commercial plan members. It applies to requests submitted directly by a prescriber and to requests submitted by an authorised manufacturer hub agent on the prescriber's behalf.

DRUGS REQUIRING PRIOR AUTHORIZATION

Prior authorization is required for products billed under the following codes: J3592. J3592 corresponds to velunekimab, marketed as Velunexa, 150 mg/ml single-dose prefilled syringe.

DRUGS NOT REQUIRING PRIOR AUTHORIZATION

Topical corticosteroids, topical vitamin D analogues, and office-based narrowband UVB phototherapy do not require prior authorization under this plan.

MEDICAL NECESSITY CRITERIA

Velunexa is considered medically necessary when all of the following criteria are met:

1. The patient has a confirmed diagnosis of moderate-to-severe plaque psoriasis with body surface area involvement of at least 10 percent or a PASI score of at least 12, documented by the treating clinician.
2. The patient is 18 years of age or older.
3. The patient has completed a trial of at least twelve (12) weeks of one conventional systemic agent (methotrexate, cyclosporine, or acitretin) or a documented course of phototherapy, without clinically meaningful improvement, unless every available agent is contraindicated or not tolerated.
4. Tuberculosis screening has been completed within the twelve (12) months preceding initiation and the result is negative, or a positive result has been evaluated and treated.
5. The drug is prescribed by, or in documented consultation with, a dermatologist or rheumatologist.

EXCEPTIONS

The conservative systemic therapy requirement is waived where the patient has documented hepatic impairment, is pregnant or planning pregnancy, has a history of malignancy within five years, or where all conventional systemic agents are contraindicated. The prescriber must state the contraindication in the medical record.

DOCUMENTATION REQUIREMENTS

Submitted requests must include the signed prescriber enrollment or start form, a statement of medical necessity, a clinical note documenting disease severity and body surface area, documentation of the conventional systemic therapy course and its outcome, and tuberculosis screening results dated within twelve months.

REVIEW TIMEFRAMES

Standard requests are adjudicated within five (5) business days of receipt of a complete submission. Expedited requests are adjudicated within seventy-two (72) hours. An incomplete submission is returned with a written statement of the missing element and the review clock restarts on receipt of the complete packet.

CODING

CODE	TYPE	DESCRIPTION
J3592	HCPCS	Velunekimab, per billing unit
58291-0150-01	NDC	Velunexa 150 mg/mL single-dose prefilled syringe
L40.0	ICD-10-CM	Psoriasis vulgaris

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